



Bitcoin usage in India is already on the rise with a limited reach but in a diverse distribution.

in exchanges and having any worthwhile future as a mainstream currency. As a venue for learning more about Bitcoins, this conference gave a thorough introduction to the elementary concepts of Bitcoin mining and usage. However the talks given about its feasibility from a financial point of view were lacking in depth and painted a slightly oversimplified image, specially within the Indian context. The majority of presenters were trying to encourage the Indian audience to take an active interest in Bitcoin mining as a means to profitability by introducing mining products and pitching the benefits of online exchanges where Bitcoins could be traded. The real question of how Bitcoin could benefit Indian systems was not dealt with and only briefly focussed on the concept of cashless payments as a whole.

The conference, as a first of its kind, joins Amsterdam and Singapore as a Global Bitcoin Conference, but wasn't able to generate as much confidence in some attendees who were looking for a more India centric discussion. Bitcoin continues to deal with issues of domestic regulation and merchant support within India which is critical in making it a mainstream currency. The intense focus on trading reduces the potential of Bitcoin as currency and places it strictly in the world of a pseudo-currency, like shares that can be traded online for profit. The other focus is entirely based on inviting investment for mining activities without clearly explaining the true costs. More conferences and meetups that deal with the real complexities of Bitcoin in India are needed and this conference was a basic start towards people networking and building trust.